

ITINERANT RELATIVE CLAUSES IN TIGRINYA¹

Gioia Cacchioli

gioia.cacchioli@unige.ch

ABSTRACT: This squib investigates the distribution of restrictive relative clauses within the determiner phrase in the Ethio-semitic language Tigrinya. Contrary to the widely held assumption that restrictive relative clauses occupy a fixed positions in the nominal spine, Tigrinya allows them to appear in several prenominal and one postnominal positions without clear interpretive differences. This unexpected flexibility from an understudied language poses a puzzle for current theories of DP structure and raises questions that call for further investigation.

KEYWORDS: relative clauses, DP, Tigrinya, Ethio-semitic, syntax

1 Introduction

It is widely assumed that restrictive relative clauses (henceforth RC) occupy a uniform structural position within the nominal spine (Cinque 2013, 2020). The nominal spine constitutes a hierarchically ordered sequence of projections, each hosting a specific class of nominal modifiers, such as determiners, adjectives, and numerals (a.o. Cinque 1996, 2005, 2010). A nominal configuration containing the noun head, a restrictive relative clause, a demonstrative, an adjective, and a cardinal numeral (henceforth, numeral) is assumed to exhibit the following merge order:

(1) [DemP ... [RC ... [NumP ... [AP ... NP]]]] (adapted from (Cinque 2008:9,(15)))

We therefore expect, all else being equal, a single word order for RCs within a nominal spine.

The Ethio-Semitic language Tigrinya, however, provides a notable counterexample. In this language, restrictive relative clauses display a high degree of positional flexibility among nominal modifiers. They can occur prenominally in three distinct positions, in addition to a postnominal position, as illustrated in (2).

- | | | | | |
|-----|----|-------------------------------|----|-------------------------------|
| (2) | a. | Dem - RC - Num - A - N | c. | Dem - Num - A - RC - N |
| | b. | Dem - Num - RC - A - N | d. | Dem - Num - A - N - RC |

¹I am grateful to Ur Shlonsky, Ivano Caponigro, Jason Overfelt, and Tom Meadows for valuable discussions of the data presented here. I am also deeply indebted to my consultants Tekle Weldemhret, Tewelde Zaid and Solomon Haile for their invaluable assistance.

In existing grammars, encyclopedic entries, and the limited descriptive literature on Tigrinya, relative clauses are generally reported to be prenominal, though in rare and specific contexts they may also appear postnominally (Palmer 1962). Within the generative framework, two studies have proposed syntactic analyses of relative clauses in Tigrinya, focusing exclusively on prenominal restrictive forms (Overfelt 2009, Cacchioli 2023). To the best of my knowledge, no proposal has yet been advanced for the syntax of the (optional) postnominal realization of relative clauses. Moreover, the position of relative clauses with respect to other nominal modifiers has, to date, received no comprehensive treatment.

This squib offers a systematic description of the attested and unattested word orders of restrictive relative clauses within the determiner phrase in Tigrinya. Its primary aim is to advance our understanding of the syntax of relative clauses by presenting novel empirical evidence from an understudied language. A detailed theoretical analysis is deferred to future research.²

Unless otherwise noted, the data³ were collected during fieldwork with three Eritrean native speakers of Tigrinya who have resided in Geneva (Switzerland) since the 2010s. The data were elicited through standard judgment and translation tasks.

This squib is organized as follows. Section 2 outlines the basic morphosyntactic properties of nouns, nominal modifiers, and object restrictive relative clauses in Tigrinya. Section 4 provides a systematic description of the attested and unattested word orders of restrictive relative clauses within the determiner phrase. Section 5 discusses the findings and offers hypotheses to account for them.

2 Background on Tigrinya

In this section, I present the morphosyntactic properties of demonstratives, adjectives, numerals, and nouns in Tigrinya, as well as those of relative clauses that are relevant to the subsequent discussion.

²This squib builds on research conducted in 2018 in collaboration with Ur Shlonsky and Bahareh Samimi, following preliminary fieldwork I carried out during my M.A. studies. The data presented here were subsequently collected by myself in 2020 and 2024.

³Transcription conventions in Tigrinya vary considerably across sources. Glosses follow the Leipzig Glossing Rules, except that capital SM and capital OM are used for subject and object agreement morphology on verbal forms, respectively. In citing Eritrean and Ethiopian authors, I follow the conventions proposed by Meyer & Treis (2021) to accurately reflect regional naming practices.

for a detailed analysis of the clausal prefix $z(i)$ -, see [Cacchioli \(2023\)](#).

3 Relative Clauses among Nominal Modifiers

The previous section established that demonstratives, numerals, and adjectives in Tigrinya precede the noun they modify and appear in a fixed order. The following section examines how restrictive RCs interact with this structure.

3.1 Dem-Num-RC-N

I now add an RC to a sentence like the one in (11), which contains a demonstrative and a numeral.

- (11) ʔit-en kilite dɛɖdabe-tat niwɔh-ti ʔi-jjen
DEM-FP two letter.F-P long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
'The two letters are long.'

The RC, containing a null subject pronoun, can occur in three different positions, as in (12).⁵

- (12) a. ʔit-ɛn **zi-ts'ɛhaf-in** kilite deɓɓabe-tat niwaħ-ti
DEM-FP Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP two letter.F-P long-F
ʔi-jjɛn
BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- b. ʔit-ɛn kilite **zi-ts'ɛhaf-in** deɓɓabe-tat niwaħ-ti
DEM-FP two Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP letter.F-P long-F
ʔi-jjɛn
BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- c. %ʔit-ɛn kilite deɓɓabe-tat **zi-ts'ɛhaf-in** niwaħ-ti
DEM-FP two letter.F-P Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP long-F
ʔi-jjɛn
BE.PRES-SM.3FP
'The two letters that he wrote are long.'

The only unacceptable order is when the RC precedes the demonstrative, as shown in (13). The sequence RC–Dem is ungrammatical in all subsequent examples as well.

⁵The 3MS subject marker *ε* of the relativized Perfective form has phonologically merged with the 3FP object marker *-in*, which cross-references the object *debdabetat* ‘letters’.

- (13) ***zi-ts'ehaf-in** ʔit-ɛn kilite dəbdabe-tat niwah-ti ʔi-jjen
 Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP DEM-FP two letter.F-P long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
 'The two letters that he wrote are long.'

An RC with an overt subject, such as *ʔit-i səbʔai* 'the man' (immediately preceding the *z(i)*-marked verb), can likewise appear in three different positions, as illustrated below.

- (14) a. ʔit-ɛn ʔit-i səbʔai **zi-ts'ehaf-in** kilite dəbdabe-tat
 DEM-FP DEM-MS man Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP two letter.F-P
 niwah-ti ʔi-jjen
 long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- b. %ʔit-ɛn kilite ʔit-i səbʔai **zi-ts'ehaf-in** dəbdabe-tat
 DEM-FP two DEM-MS man Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP letter.F-P
 niwah-ti ʔi-jjen
 long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- c. %ʔit-ɛn kilite dəbdabe-tat ʔit-i səbʔai **zi-ts'ehaf-in**
 DEM-FP two letter.F-P DEM-MS man Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP
 niwah-ti ʔi-jjen
 long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
 'The two letters that the man wrote are long.'

In the examples above, RCs with an overt subject are slightly less acceptable in two of the positions than those with a null subject.

The following table summarizes the possible orders discussed above, excluding the configuration in which the RC precedes the demonstrative.

	null <i>pro</i> SUBJ	DP SUBJ
(a) Dem- RC -Num-N	✓	✓
(b) Dem-Num- RC -N	✓	%
(c) Dem-Num-N- RC	%	%

Table 1: Acceptability of the distribution of a Relative Clause among Dem-Num-N.

The order preferred by my consultants is the one in which the RC appears between Dem and Num. Acceptability decreases as the RC moves further from this position.⁶ In other words, the RC is generally more acceptable in a prenominal than in a postnominal position. [Palmer \(1962\)](#) likewise notes that the postnominal position is only *rarely* grammatical. The preferred order corresponds to the universal base structure of nominal phrases ([Cinque 2008:9](#)).

⁶Two consultants out of three accept order (c) with a null *pro* subject and orders (c) and (d) with an overt DP subject.

3.2 Dem-A-RC-N

I now add an RC to a sentence like the one in (15), which contains a demonstrative and an adjective.

- (15) ʔit-en ts'ibʊat dəbdabe-tat niwaḥ-ti ʔi-jjen
DEM-FP beautiful letter.F-P long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
'The beautiful letters are long.'

The RC with a null subject pronoun can appear in three different positions, as shown in (16). As noted above, it cannot precede the demonstrative.

- (16) a. ʔit-ɛn **zi-ts'ɛhaf-in** ts'ibuʁat dəbdabe-tat niwəh-ti
DEM-FP Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP beautiful letter.F-P long-F
ʔi-jjɛn
BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- b. ʔit-ɛn ts'ibuʁat **zi-ts'ɛhaf-in** dəbdabe-tat niwəh-ti
DEM-FP beautiful Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP letter.F-P long-F
ʔi-jjɛn
BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- c. ʔit-ɛn ts'ibuʁat dəbdabe-tat **zi-ts'ɛhaf-in** niwəh-ti
DEM-FP beautiful letter.F-P Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP long-F
ʔi-jjɛn
BE.PRES-SM.3FP
'The beautiful letters that he wrote are long.'

When two adjectives occur in the sentence, the RC can appear in four different positions.

- (17) a. ʔit-en **zi-ts'ɛhaf-in** ts'ibuxat ts'aŋeda dəbdabe-tat niwaŋ-ti
DEM-FP Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP beautiful white letter.F-P long-F
ʔi-jjen
BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- b. ʔit-en ts'ibuxat **zi-ts'ɛhaf-in** ts'aŋeda dəbdabe-tat niwaŋ-ti
DEM-FP beautiful Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP white letter.F-P long-F
ʔi-jjen
BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- c. ʔit-en ts'ibuxat ts'aŋeda **zi-ts'ɛhaf-in** dəbdabe-tat niwaŋ-ti
DEM-FP beautiful white Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP letter.F-P long-F
ʔi-jjen
BE.PRES-SM.3FP

- d. ʔit-ɛn ts'ibuʁat ts'aʃɛda dɛbdabe-tat **zi-ts'ɛhaf-in** niwah-ti
 DEM-FP beautiful white letter.F-P Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP long-F
 ʔi-jjɛn
 BE.PRES-SM.3FP
 'The beautiful white letters that he wrote are long.'

When the adjective is heavier (i.e. a complex expression rather than a single word) the RC is preferred in a position preceding the adjective, even when it contains an overt subject.

- (18) a. ʔit-ɛn **zi-ts'ɛhaf-in** bizuh siʃɛɛ-tat
 DEM-FP Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP a.lot image-P
 z-ɛll-o-win dɛbdabe-tat niwah-ti ʔi-jjɛn
 Zi-BE₁.PRES-SM.3MS-OM.3FP letter.F-P long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
 b. ʔʔit-ɛn bizuh siʃɛɛ-tat z-ɛll-o-win
 DEM-FP a.lot image-P Zi-BE₁.PRES-SM.3MS-OM.3FP
zi-ts'ɛhaf-in dɛbdabe-tat niwah-ti ʔi-jjɛn
 Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP letter.F-P long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
 c. ʔʔit-ɛn bizuh siʃɛɛ-tat z-ɛll-o-win dɛbdabe-tat
 DEM-FP a.lot image-P BE.PRES-SM.3FP letter.F-P
zi-ts'ɛhaf-in niwah-ti ʔi-jjɛn
 Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
 'The letters full of images that he wrote are long.'

The examples above indicate that processing principles operate independently of the general preference for placing heavy modifiers after lighter ones. A similar phenomenon is observed in Italian, as illustrated in (19) and (20), where the RC is in bold.⁷

- (19) a. La lettera interessante **che mi ha scritto** è su-l tavolo.
 the letter interesting that to-me has written is on-the table
 b. *La lettera **che mi ha scritto** interessante è su-l tavolo.
 the letter that to-me has written interesting is on-the table
 'The interesting letter that he wrote to me is on the table.'
 (20) a. La lettera ricca di metafore **che mi ha scritto** è su-l tavolo.
 the letter full_of_metaphors that to-me has written is on-the table
 b. La lettera **che mi ha scritto** ricca di metafore è su-l tavolo.
 the letter that to-me has written full_of_metaphors is on-the table
 'The letter full of metaphors that he wrote to me is on the table.'

The sentences in (19) contain the simple adjective *interessante* 'interesting', which may precede

⁷I thank Ivano Caponigro for drawing my attention to these examples.

but not follow the RC. In contrast, those in (20) feature the complex adjective *ricca di metafore* ‘full of metaphors’, which may occur either before or after the RC. The weight of nominal complement modifiers thus appears to influence the placement of RCs across languages.

We have observed that the acceptability of the sentences above varies with the weight of nominal modifiers. What happens when the RC itself differs in weight? Does this affect the acceptability of its placement? To test this, compare example (16) with (21), which includes two phonologically overt subjects: a monosyllabic subject, *Dan*, and a multisyllabic one, *?iti ?iziju niwih seb?ai* ‘the very tall man’.

- (21) a. *?it-en Dan/{?it-i ?iziju niwih seb?ai} zi-ts’ehaf-in*
 DEM-FP Dan/DEM-MS very tall man Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP
ts’ibuʁat dɛbdabe-tat niwah-ti ?i-jjen
 beautiful letter.F-P long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- b. *?it-en ts’ibuʁat Dan/{%?it-i ?iziju niwih seb?ai}*
 DEM-FP beautiful Dan/DEM-MS very tall man
zi-ts’ehaf-in dɛbdabe-tat niwah-ti ?i-jjen
 Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP letter.F-P long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- c. *?it-en ts’ibuʁat dɛbdabe-tat Dan/{%?it-i ?iziju niwih seb?ai}*
 DEM-FP beautiful letter.F-P Dan/DEM-MS very tall man
zi-ts’ehaf-in niwah-ti ?i-jjen
 Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
 ‘The beautiful letters that Dan/the very tall man wrote are long.’

The examples above show that as the subject becomes longer, the RC decreases in acceptability (only one consultant out of three accepts it when it is farther from the demonstrative).

The following table summarizes the possible word orders observed when the RC co-occurs with one adjective, excluding the configuration in which the RC precedes the demonstrative.

	SUBJ			heavy A
	<i>pro</i>	short	long	
(a) Dem- RC -A-N	✓	✓	✓	✓
(b) Dem-A- RC -N	✓	✓	%	?
(c) Dem-A-N- RC	✓	✓	%	?

Table 2: Acceptability of the Distribution of a Relative Clause among Dem-A-N.

Once again, the preferred order is the one in which the RC appears between the demonstrative and the numeral. Note also that when the relative clause co-occurs with a normal-sized

3.3 Dem-Num-A-RC-N

(22) ʔit-en kilite ts'ibuxat deɓdabe-tat niwah-ti ʔi-ʝen
DEM-FP two beautiful letter.F-P long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
'The two beautiful letters are long.'

(23) a. ʔit-ən (ʔit-i səbʔai) **zi-ts'əhaf-in** kilite ts'ibuʁat
DEM-FP DEM-MS man Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP two beautiful
dəbdabe-tat niwaḥ-ti ʔi-jjen
letter.F-P long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP

b. ʔit-ən kilite (ʔit-i səbʔai) **zi-ts'əhaf-in** ts'ibuʁat
DEM-FP two DEM-MS man Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP beautiful
dəbdabe-tat niwaḥ-ti ʔi-jjen
letter.F-P long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP

c. ʔit-ən kilite ts'ibuʁat (%ʔit-i səbʔai) **zi-ts'əhaf-in**
DEM-FP two beautiful DEM-MS man Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP
dəbdabe-tat niwaḥ-ti ʔi-jjen
letter.F-P long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP

d. ʔit-ən kilite ts'ibuʁat dəbdabe-tat (ʔit-i səbʔai)
DEM-FP two beautiful letter.F-P DEM-MS man
zi-ts'əhaf-in niwaḥ-ti ʔi-jjen
Zi-write.PFV-SM.3MS-OM.3FP long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
'The two beautiful letters that he/the man wrote are long.'

10

- (24) a. ?it-en b-it-i se?ai **zi-ts'ehef-a** kilite ts'ibu?at de?dabe-tat
 DEM-FP by-DEM.MS man Zi-write.PASS-SM.3FS two beautiful letter.F-P
 niwa?-ti ?i-jjen
 long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- b. ?it-en kilite b-it-i se?ai **zi-ts'ehef-a** ts'ibu?at de?dabe-tat
 DEM-FP two by-DEM.MS man Zi-write.PASS-SM.3FS beautiful letter.F-P
 niwa?-ti ?i-jjen
 long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- c. ?it-en kilite ts'ibu?at b-it-i se?ai **zi-ts'ehef-a** de?dabe-tat
 DEM-FP two beautiful by-DEM.MS man Zi-write.PASS-SM.3FS letter.F-P
 niwa?-ti ?i-jjen
 long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
- d. ?it-en kilite ts'ibu?at de?dabe-tat b-it-i se?ai **zi-ts'ehef-a**
 DEM-FP two beautiful letter.F-P by-DEM.MS man Zi-write.PASS-SM.3FS
 niwa?-ti ?i-jjen
 long-F BE.PRES-SM.3FP
 'The two beautiful letters that are written by the man are long.'

The different positions illustrated above are schematically summarized in the table below.

	active		passive
	<i>pro</i> SUBJ	DP SUBJ	
(a) Dem- RC -Num-A-N	✓	✓	✓
(b) Dem-Num- RC -A-N	✓	✓	✓
(c) Dem-Num-A- RC -N	✓	%	✓
(d) Dem-Num-A-N- RC	✓	✓	✓

Table 3: Acceptability of the Distribution of a Relative Clause among nominal modifiers.

As shown in the table above, when an RC co-occurs with adjectives and numerals, it is acceptable in four distinct positions.⁸ When the subject is an overt DP, however, the position of the RC between the adjective and the noun is less preferred.

4 Discussion

As shown, restrictive relative clauses in Tigrinya can occur in multiple positions among nominal modifiers without any clear difference in meaning. If subtle interpretive distinctions exist, they were not detected or reported by my consultants during fieldwork.

⁸For a description of the possible word orders when an RC co-occurs with possessors, see Gebregziabher (2013).

How can this phenomenon be accounted for? At the interpretive level, one possibility is that, unlike in languages such as English, Tigrinya allows the relative clause to modify different portions of the DP (either the noun alone or the noun together with one or more nominal modifiers) depending on its linear position. For example, in (23), the RC modifies *two beautiful letters* in (23-a), *beautiful letters* in (23-b), and simply *letters* in (23-c). The exact interpretation of (23-d), and thus the semantic contrast between prenominal and postnominal RCs in Tigrinya, requires further investigation. Semantically, each position could correspond to the intersection of distinct sets: for instance, the set of *twos*, the set of *beautiful* individuals, and the set of *letters* in (23-a); the set of *beautiful* individuals and the set of *letters* in (23-b); and so forth.

Alternatively, the variation may result from extraposition driven by information-structural factors. In this view, the different word orders reflect distinct focus configurations. This perspective aligns with analyses attributing DP-internal reordering to Focus movement (Syed 2015). Assuming a Focus projection in the nominal domain (Aboh 2004), the RC might move according to which element is focalized, potentially adjoining to it. This is consistent with the role of the copula *?ijju* as a focus marker in (Cacchioli 2024). A more detailed analysis incorporating focus and prosody (Zubizarreta 1998) is needed, but must be left for future research.

From a syntactic perspective, it is also possible that the constructions under discussion are not strictly *restrictive* relative clauses. While the English translations suggest a restrictive interpretation, recall that Tigrinya demonstratives function both as determiners and as distal demonstratives. Under the latter use, the RCs would be *non-restrictive* (or appositive) and could freely adjoin wherever semantic composition permits; hence their occurrence in multiple positions. This approach, however, must still explain the exclusion of the pre-demonstrative position.

If, instead, these clauses are truly *restrictive*, one could hypothesize that they are base-generated in the postnominal position - contrary to Cinque (2008, 2010, 2020) - and move to other positions within the DP. Yet any analysis relying on roll-up or partial movement of other constituents is untenable (Cinque 2005).

Further research is therefore required to determine whether the variation in relative clause placement in Tigrinya arises from information structure, syntactic base generation, or a combination of both.

References

- Aboh, Enoch. 2004. Topic and focus within d. *Linguistics in the Netherlands* 21:1–12.
- Cacchioli, Gioia. 2023. The tigrinya *zi-* prefix: A morphological reflex of successive-cyclic movement. *Brill's Journal of Afroasiatic Languages and Linguistics* 15:232–261.
- Cacchioli, Gioia. 2024. *A note on verum focus in tigrinya*, 24–41. Olomouc Modern Language Series. Olomouc: Palacký University.
- Cinque, Guglielmo. 1996. *On the evidence for partial n-movement in the romance dp*, 287–309. Cambridge Studies in Linguistics. Cambridge/New York: Cambridge University Press.
- Cinque, Guglielmo. 2005. Deriving greenberg's universal 20 and its exceptions. *Linguistic Inquiry* 36:315–332.
- Cinque, Guglielmo. 2008. More on the indefinite character of the head of restrictive relative clauses. *Rivista di Grammatica Generativa* 33:3–24. Padova, Unipress.
- Cinque, Guglielmo. 2010. *The syntax of adjectives: A comparative study*. Cambridge (Mass.): The MIT Press.
- Cinque, Guglielmo. 2013. *Typological studies: Word order and relative clauses*. New York, London: Routledge.
- Cinque, Guglielmo. 2020. *The syntax of relative clauses: A unified analysis*. Cambridge Studies in Linguistics. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Gebregziabher, Keffyalew. 2013. Projecting possessors: A morphosyntactic investigation of nominal possession in tigrinya. Ph.d. thesis, University of Calgary, Calgary.
- Kogan, Leonid E. 1997. *Tigrinya*, 424–445. London: Routledge.
- Leslau, Wolf. 1941. *Documents tigrinya (Éthiopien septentrional): Grammaire et textes*. Paris: Librairie C. Klincksieck.
- Mason, John. 1996. *Tigrinya grammar*. Laurenceville: The Red Sea Press, 2 edition. First published 1994 by the publisher.
- Meyer, Ronny, & Yvonne Treis. 2021. How to quote ethiopian authors in linguistic publication. *Afrika und Übersee* 94:80–90.
- Nazareth Amlesom Kifle. 2011. Tigrinya applicatives in lexical-functional grammar. Ph.d. thesis, University of Bergen.
- Overfelt, Jason D. 2009. The syntax of relative clause constructions in tigrinya. Ma thesis, Purdue University.
- Palmer, Frank R. 1955. The 'broken plurals' of tigrinya. *Bulletin of the School of Oriental and African Studies* 17:548–566.
- Palmer, Frank R. 1962. Relative clauses in tigrinya. *Journal of Semitic Studies* 7:36–43.
- Syed, Saurov. 2015. *Focus-movement within the bangla dp*, 332–341. Somerville (MA): Cascadilla Proceedings Project.
- Zubizarreta, M.-L. 1998. Prosody, focus, and word order. Ph.d. thesis, MIT, Cambridge (Mass.).